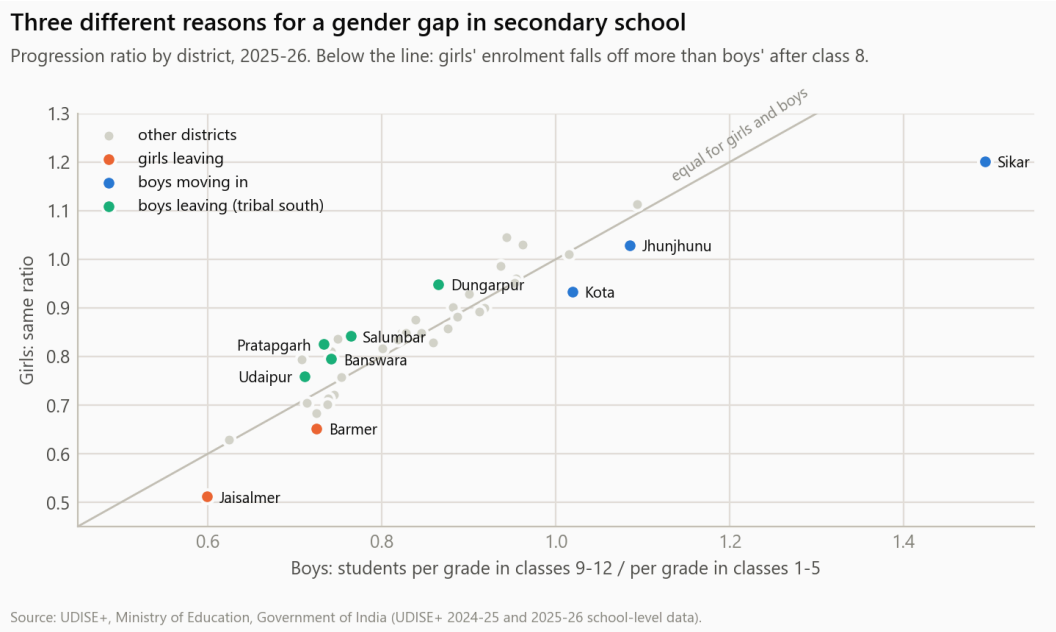
Keeping girls in secondary school in Rajasthan: three findings for funders and NGOs

Policy brief, October 2026. Based on UDISE+ school-level data for all 41 districts, 2024-25 and 2025-26.

At a glance (2025-26). Rajasthan has 1,06,167 schools with students in classes 1-12, 1.50 crore students and 7.93 lakh teachers (18.9 students per teacher). 6.7% of schools have a single teacher. The tribal-majority south is furthest behind: Banswara, Salumbar and Pratapgarh have the three weakest infrastructure scores in the state (index 64-68 against a state average of 80), and with Dungarpur they are four of the five districts with the most single-teacher schools (up to 19.9% in Pratapgarh).

1. One gender gap, three different problems

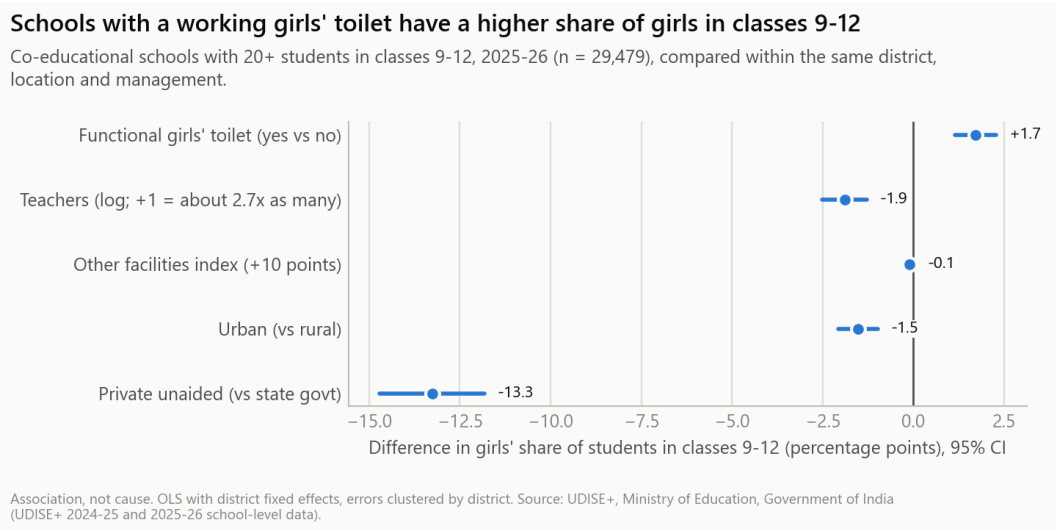


In 17 of the 41 districts, girls make up a smaller share of students in classes 9-12 than in classes 1-5; in the other 24, a larger one. The size and sign of this gap hide three different situations:

- **Girls are leaving** in **Jaisalmer and Barmer**. For every girl per grade in classes 1-5, Jaisalmer has only 0.51 per grade in classes 9-12, the lowest in the state (boys: 0.60).
- **Boys are arriving** in **Sikar, Kota and Jhunjhunu**. Sikar has 1.49 boys per grade in classes 9-12 for every boy per grade in classes 1-5: boys come from elsewhere to these coaching hubs. Girls' share falls because boys are added, not because girls leave.
- **Boys are leaving** in the **tribal south** (Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh, Salumbar, Udaipur), where girls' share *rises* after class 8.

So what. A district's gender gap alone is a poor targeting tool. Girls' transition programmes (secondary schools within reach, transport, hostels, community outreach) belong in Jaisalmer and Barmer. In Sikar and Kota the gap reflects migration *into* the district, not a girls' dropout crisis. In the tribal south, the priority is boys' retention, alongside the infrastructure and teacher gaps above.

2. Girls' toilets and government schools go with more girls in classes 9-12



We compared 29,479 co-educational schools with classes 9-12, each only with schools in the **same district**, location and type of management:

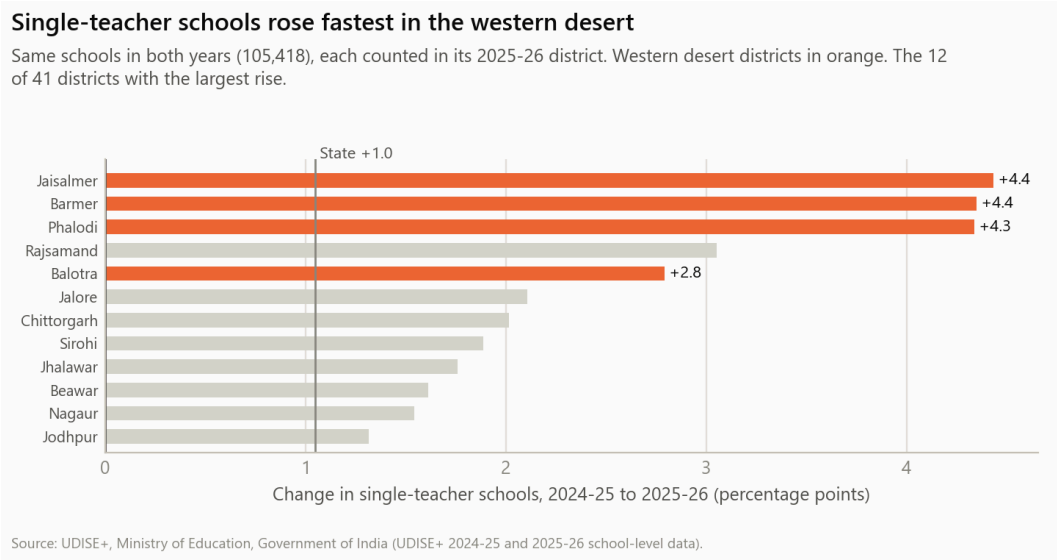
- Schools with a **functional girls' toilet** have a girls' share about **1.7 percentage points higher** (95% confidence interval: 1.2 to 2.3). Other facilities show no link once the toilet is accounted for.

- **Private unaided schools** have a girls' share **13 points lower** than state-government schools. In all 41 districts, girls' share drops more between primary and senior classes in non-government schools than in government schools; government schools teach 61.5% of all girls in classes 9-12.

So what. 2,420 of the 34,024 schools with classes 9-12 still lack a functional girls' toilet, and 1,08,636 girls study in them. Making those toilets work (not only building them, but maintaining them) is a concrete, countable target. Because government schools carry most girls through secondary school, strengthening them is the main channel for girls' secondary education. These are associations: a school may have a toilet *because* it has more girls. A funded pilot with a before-and-after comparison would show how much of the link is causal.

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3. Teachers are thinning out where girls already drop out most



Comparing the **same 1,05,418 schools** in both years (so new schools, closures and the 180 schools moved from Alwar to Kotputli-Behror do not distort the picture), the share of single-teacher schools rose by 1.0 point state-wide but by **4.4 points in Jaisalmer and Barmer, 4.3 in Phalodi and 2.8 in Balotra**. In Jaisalmer it went from 12.3% to 16.7% in one year. Jaisalmer, Barmer and Balotra each lost 2.6-3.5% of the teachers in these same schools, while the median district saw no change.

So what. The western desert combines the largest loss of girls relative to boys after class 8 (Jaisalmer, Barmer) with a fast-worsening teacher supply. Teacher deployment there deserves early attention from the state, and NGOs running learning or teaching-assistant programmes can prioritise single-teacher schools in these four districts. The data shows where teachers were lost, not why (transfers, retirements or vacancies); district education offices can confirm the cause.

Method and caveats. Data: UDISE+ school-level files (profile, facility, teacher, enrolment) for all 41 districts, processed through a tested pipeline; the 2024-25 state totals match the officially published figures exactly (schools, teachers, enrolment, single-teacher and zero-enrolment schools, government schools). UDISE+ is self-reported by schools. All findings are correlations, not causal effects. Full analysis: `notebooks/analysis.ipynb`; data notes: `DATA_QUALITY_LOG.md`.

Source: UDISE+, Ministry of Education, Government of India.